



Winding Tree

Winding Tree Files for FINMA Audit, TGE Postponed until Feb 1, 2018



Maksim Izmaylov

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Over the course of the past few weeks, we were in constant communication with our legal advisors in Switzerland over the press release that was issued by FINMA (Swiss Financial Market Supervisory Authority). We consider that the position taken by FINMA is a positive development in the regulatory landscape, which will help the public to distinguish between good blockchain projects and the noise. In order to ensure that our TGE is conducted in a way that is fully compliant with Swiss law, we have decided to obtain a formal ruling of the Swiss authority prior to commencing the TGE. Unfortunately, this means that we need to postpone the TGE by 12 weeks, i.e. until Feb 1, 2018. We understand it's a short notice, but please read on.

Why is the ruling necessary?

Our team is convinced that obtaining a formal approval by a regulator only benefits the project as well as its contributors. Among the proliferation of tokens being issued in recent months, the existing global regulatory uncertainties and the fact that regulators in numerous countries are attempting to halt dubious projects, we want to assure that our project must be perceived as a serious token project.

Our lawyers are already working closely with FINMA to speed up the process of auditing our TGE structure and we are hoping to be one of the first projects to obtain a FINMA approval. Such approval will facilitate the onboarding of companies onto the platform and boost adoption of Winding Tree. **Our highest priority is the success of the Winding Tree platform.**

What Does it Mean for Me?

First of all, it means that we will launch the TGE later than anticipated. Our planned date for token distribution was November 15th, 2017, but with this new development, we will hold it on February 15th, 2018.

The three-month delay **gives us a chance to find more partners on both sides of the marketplace** and have a wildly successful TGE. **We already have a strong interest in the platform from U.S. and Asian suppliers** who have raised concerns about their respective Governments' rulings on tokens. With a FINMA ruling determining our token as a utility token, we will be able to quickly on-board the suppliers. **Moreover, the ruling will facilitate listings on major exchanges by providing a legal framework for compliance.**

Our software development plans are not changing, we still are fully on track to release code according to our schedule. By the way, check out [the code we've posted so far](#). **On November 1st we are planning to launch a demo app for hotels on the test net**, stay tuned for more news from our engineering team led by Jakub Vysoky and Augusto Lemble.

The Decision Timeline

We apologize for this announcement coming out too close to the originally planned TGE date, but no one on our team or even on the team of our legal counsel could predict this. Up until October 18th we did not know about this change and in a few days after that we tried to find ways to not postpone the TGE, but after lengthy conversations with our team, our advisory board, and our lawyers, we concluded that this decision is the best for the platform and, consecutively, for all the parties involved.

Questions?

We're always available on:

- Rocket Chat: <https://windingtree.rocket.chat>
- Telegram: <https://t.me/windingtree>

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